UAE Federal Decree-Law No. (26) of 2022 Regulating Civil Aviation in the United Arab Emirates

General Civil Aviation Authority (GCAA) Federal Aviation Mandate

Regulatory Domain: Aviation Safety / Airspace Sovereignty

Article (14) - Precedence of Manned Aircraft and Life-Safety Operations

In all shared and uncontrolled airspace across the United Arab Emirates, unmanned aircraft systems (UAS) shall unconditionally yield right-of-way to manned aircraft, search-and-rescue flights, and emergency medical helicopters (HEMS). Upon detection of a manned intruder within 2,000 meters, the UAS shall initiate emergency descent or corridor evacuation to eliminate mid-air collision hazards.

Article (22) - Controlled Airspace Authorization and BVLOS Flight Plans

No unmanned aircraft shall operate Beyond Visual Line of Sight (BVLOS) without an active, validated flight authorization approved by GCAA. Real-time telemetry reporting altitude, coordinates, and velocity is mandatory.

Article (45) - Incident Investigation and Audit Record Preservation

Operators and UTM service providers must record and preserve complete, immutable flight and decision logs for a minimum period of three years to support accident investigation and regulatory compliance reviews.